

The Six Factions of Scyndos

THE LEDGER

Geographical Presence: Headquartered in the citadel of the same name at the heart of First Light. Every city-state maintains a local registrar's office answering back to First Light, though enforcement thins considerably the further one travels.

Founded as: The first pillar of the Order of Balance, raised by the Unwed Widow to bring identity to a shattered land - a ledger to record every name, so that no one who survived the Sundering would ever again simply go unaccounted for.

Description of their work presently: Registration still happens, names are still recorded, debts are still tracked with precision but the impartiality that once defined the institution eroded over time and never fully recovered. Those who can pay the registration fee are recorded, protected, and accounted for. Those who cannot simply stop appearing in the books, and a person absent from the Ledger cannot be searched for, married, taxed, or mourned by any official process - they exist only to the people who still remember them personally, which the Ledger considers, quietly, someone else's problem.

Notable NPCs:

- **Scribe Merville Ordyn:** Head Custodian of the Ledger, the single living authority on what the citadel's archives actually contain. Precise, unreadable, and the only person in First Light who could confirm or deny the old rumors about the seven vanished, if he ever chose to.
- **Archivist Caleb Friar:** A junior archivist who is clumsy with his work and often known as the Eraser (since he messes up records). He hails from a family of scholars who served as archivists and scribes since the first order was established.

THE KNEELING FAITH

Geographical Presence: The primary shrine sits in First Light, built around the Everburning Candle itself. Smaller shrines and roadside chapels are scattered across

the continent. A grand chapel serves High Crest's nobility, humble waystone shrines dot the Golden Sea's farm roads, and a small monastic order maintaining a shrine deep within Ironspyr's cities mark their presence over Scyndos.

Founded as: The second pillar of the Order of Balance, raised to bring reverence - a faith built to honor the Bearer's unending, silent resolve to keep the land from drifting apart.

Description of their work presently: The Faith still tends its shrines, leads prayer services and funerary rites. The problem is what it has quietly stopped saying. Over the generations, sermons shifted their focus entirely to the Bearer, with no evidence left of any other entity that might have ever helped the people. The youngest generation of the devout believe the Everburning Candle to be the Bearer's beacon, a symbol of hope and resolve for their prayers.

Notable NPCs:

- **Ferdinand Marlow:** Head of the Kneeling Faith (*High Kneeler*), an unnervingly kind man who has spent his career believing the Widow's story was simplified for the faithful's own good, rather than erased for anyone else's convenience.
- **Penelope Cross:** One of the newly initiated *Obedient*, she's here to find more details about her guardian who was called twelve years ago. She has changed her name since to not bear the mark of Nyr.

THE CONCORD

Geographical Presence: Convenes formally in **First Light**, but its real strength runs through **High Crest**, where the wealthiest merchant houses set most of its actual policy, and the **Golden Sea**, whose farmland output it was originally built to fairly distribute. **Shadowfenn**'s self-owned orchards and timber plots trade with the Concord out of choice more than loyalty.

Founded as: The third pillar of the Order of Balance, raised to bring coin - a concord meant to rebuild trade for everyone who laboured to keep Scyndos fed and supplied after the Sundering.

Description of their work presently: Trade still moves through the Concord. It simply no longer moves evenly. Scarcity (real or manufactured), and increasingly

difficult for outsiders to tell apart, has become a tool rather than a hazard. Information about where goods are actually available is worth more, in practice, than the goods themselves. High Crest's old-money houses profit from every controlled shortage. The Golden Sea's farmers, who toil to feed the land, watch trade agreements get written further and further from their favour with every harvest.

Notable NPCs:

- **Baron Cassian Thorne:** High Crest's most influential noble, holding no official Concord title and needing none. Every major trade decision in Scyndos passes through his approval eventually, whether the Concord's charter admits it or not. Trades in Fracture-touched materials: minerals, relics, and curios pulled from the Wound's edge, most of unknown provenance and danger.
 - **Felix Delacruz:** Controls the grain market - effectively sets harvest prices for three provinces and is widely (correctly) suspected of engineering shortages. He also claims to have ties to noble descendants and enjoys flaunting his wealth, hosting lavish banquets for other nobles during scarcity and drought.
 - **Voice-Elect Arla Abbott:** The Concord's official spokesperson in First Light, incompetent but well-liked, and increasingly uneasy about how much of what she publicly announces she privately had no hand in deciding.
 - **Madam Ophelia Gray:** Nominally a textiles magnate; actually runs the **Nameless Market**, an unofficial trade network that supplies goods to the Unmarked (see below) without requiring registry with the Ledger. Some suspect her benevolence comes with a cost, as no one questions the happenings of **the Sink** or the Unmarked.
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THE GUILD

Geographical Presence: Jointly headquartered in First Light and High Crest, where its sellwords are available to anyone with coin, but its retrieval work (its original purpose) reaches everywhere Scyndos has people worth finding: from the depths of Ironspyr to the dense growth of Shadowfenn.

Founded as: The fourth pillar of the Order of Balance, raised to bring survival - a guild dedicated to retrieving those separated from their families and communities across the broken land.

Description of their work presently: The Guild still finds people. It has simply started charging for the finding, and the price climbs with the difficulty of the search, with often no results delivered once coin has been procured. Noble families in High Crest have been reunited with cousins lost for a generation within a matter of weeks. Poor families in the Sink file a request and are told that the search was never a concern of the guild to begin with. Savings of the poor often spent at local taverns on meat and ale, crushing any hope the downtrodden have of finding their families. What began as an act of mercy now runs, in all but name, as a mercenary company. A smaller sect of the Guild work with the Vigil to train for the Call, often collating any information or speculation about the event to prepare for the unknown.

Notable NPCs:

- **Captain Rosa Kael:** Head of the Guild, a hardened and fair-minded commander who inherited an institution already well down this path and has made only incremental progress pulling it back.
 - **Keir Adel:** A scout who maps the edges of the Wound; one of very few people who is loyal to the Captain and trains for not just scouting but for finding out what happened to his village folk who were once called.
 - **Ramsay Durn:** The "bully" archetype; a debt collector and enforcer who works Guild contracts nobles don't want their name attached to. He's always accompanied by his lackies and found drinking his pay away in taverns down the street marked with Nameless Market.
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THE VIGIL

Geographical Presence: Based out of the Vigil Fort, a bastion in the northwest, with patrol routes running along Scyndos and concentrated attention on the Fracture itself.

Founded as: Not one of the original Four Pillars. The Vigil rose later, during the Age of Dusk, in direct response to the Cycle. It was never commissioned by the Order of Balance; it formed because someone had to investigate the Called, archive what little could be learned about the Fracture, and hold the line during the terror of Harvest week.

Description of their work presently: The Vigil enforces curfew during the week of the Harvest counting all heads in houses to record if anyone went missing, patrols the borders of the Silent Vale, and maintains the only serious archive of the called in Scyndos, although no patterns have been detected.

Notable NPCs:

- **Dallis the Dark Sister:** An old knight, scarred and eyepatched, who has led the Vigil's fieldwork for longer than most of her recruits have been alive, and trusts almost no one outside the Fort.
 - **Kniles the Whisperer:** Raised in the Warrens, self-taught and self-made, now running the Vigil's intelligence network with a precision Dallis has learned to rely on.
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THE UNMARKED

Geographical Presence: Concentrated most heavily in the Sink, First Light's slum for the unregistered. The Unmarked exist wherever the Ledger's reach has thinned: scattered camps at Shadowfenn's edges, informal settlements in the Golden Sea, and, increasingly, in Ironspyr's deepest, least-audited tunnels.

Founded as: Not founded at all, in any formal sense - the Unmarked are what's left when a family can no longer afford registration and simply stops existing on the Ledger's books. Over the cycles, the Unmarked suspected the involvement of the Ledger when it comes to the called and hence refused to register their names altogether believing this would prevent their name from being called. Two cycles ago, an unmarked did go missing as well, but somehow the inhabitants continue to live under these circumstances, as if it weren't by choice.

Description of their work presently: What was once simply a byproduct of institutional neglect has become something closer to a community, and in some quarters of the Sink, something closer to a resistance. Since their names aren't recorded, the Ledger and other pillars do not extend any assistance to this group. Instead, the Unmarked practice mutual aid, and live under constant, quiet pressure from factions like the Warrens' Red Fist, which exists largely to make sure their frustration never organizes into anything the nobility would have to actually answer for and any incidents are silenced immediately.

Faction Name	Presence	Professions	NPCs
The Ledger	Citadel in First Light (HQ); local registrar offices in every city-state, with enforcement thinning the farther from First Light	Custodians, archivists, scribes, clerks, registrars	Scribe Merville Ordyn (Head Custodian); Archivist Caleb Friar ("the Eraser")
The Kneeling Faith	Primary shrine in First Light (Everburning Candle); grand chapel in High Crest; waystone shrines across the Golden Sea; monastic order in Ironspyr	Priests/clergy ("Kneelers"), initiates ("the Obedient"), shrine-keepers	Ferdinand Marlow (High Kneeler); Penelope Cross (newly initiated Obedient)
The Concord	Convenes in First Light; real power in High Crest and the Golden Sea; trades with Shadowfenn by choice	Merchants, traders, grain/market controllers, spokespeople, landlords, wood workers, black-market brokers	Baron Cassian Thorne; Felix Delacruz; Voice-Elect Arla Abbott; Madam Ophelia Gray
The Guild	Jointly headquartered in First Light and High Crest; retrieval work reaches Ironspyr and Shadowfenn. Smaller group trains for the Call with the Vigil.	Sellswords, retrieval scouts, debt collectors/enforcers, Vigil-aligned Call researchers and warriors	Captain Rosa Kael; Keir Adel (scout); Ramsay Durn (enforcer)
The Vigil	Vigil Fort (northwest bastion); patrol routes across Scyndos, concentrated on the Fracture and Silent Vale	Knights, field patrollers, intelligence agents, archivists (of the Called)	Dallis the Dark Sister; Kniles the Whisperer

Faction Name	Presence	Professions	NPCs
The Unmarked	The Sink and The Warrens (First Light and High Crest slum, heaviest concentration); scattered camps in Shadowfenn, the Golden Sea, and deep Ironspyr	Unregistered laborers, mutual-aid organizers, black-market traders (via Nameless Market ties)	